

Microsoft 365 Admin Guide: Temporary Access Pass (TAP)

Secure First-Time Sign-In & Passwordless Onboarding

Overview

Temporary Access Pass (TAP) is a **time-limited** passcode issued by administrators that allows users to securely sign in and register authentication methods without requiring a preconfigured password. TAP supports secure onboarding and passwordless scenarios by providing short-term, controlled access.

Common Use Cases

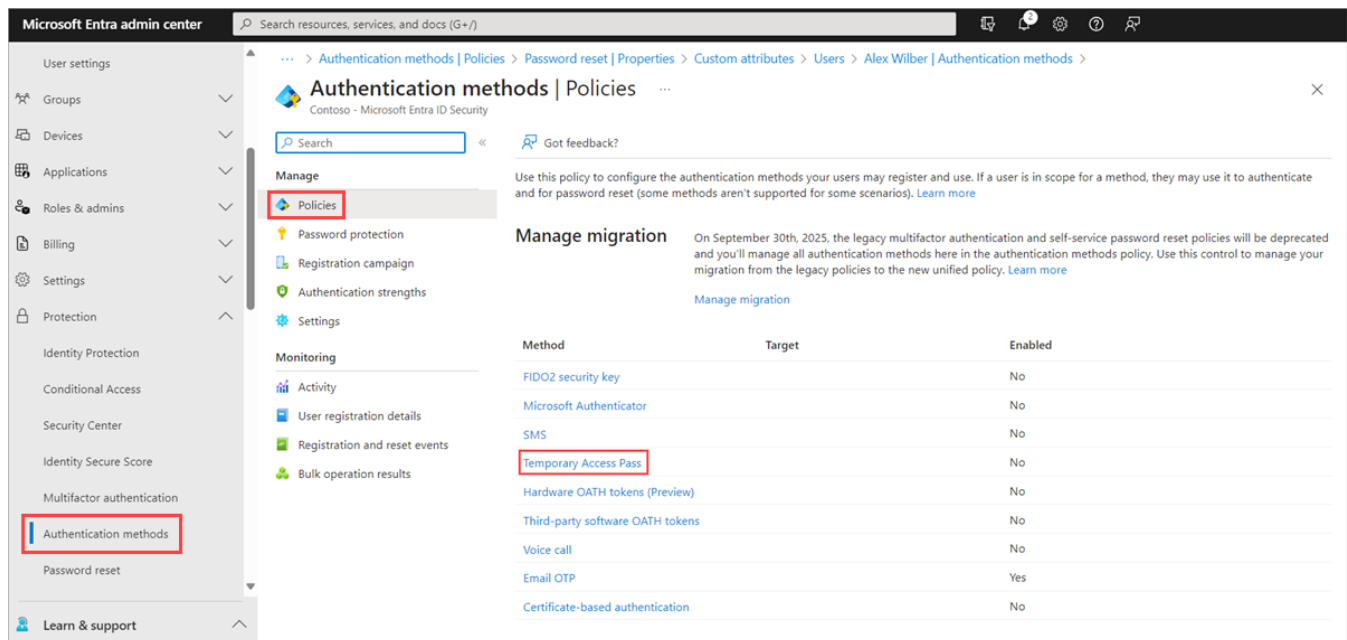
- New employee onboarding
- Passwordless deployments
- Device provisioning with Windows Autopilot
- MFA recovery scenarios
- Secure remote setup

Enable the Temporary Access Pass policy

Prerequisite: You must have the [Authentication Policy Administrator](#) role to update the TAP Authentication methods policy.

Steps:

1. Sign in to the [Microsoft Entra admin center](#).
2. In **Microsoft Entra ID** → **Authentication methods** → **Policies**.
3. From the list of available authentication methods, select **Temporary Access Pass**.



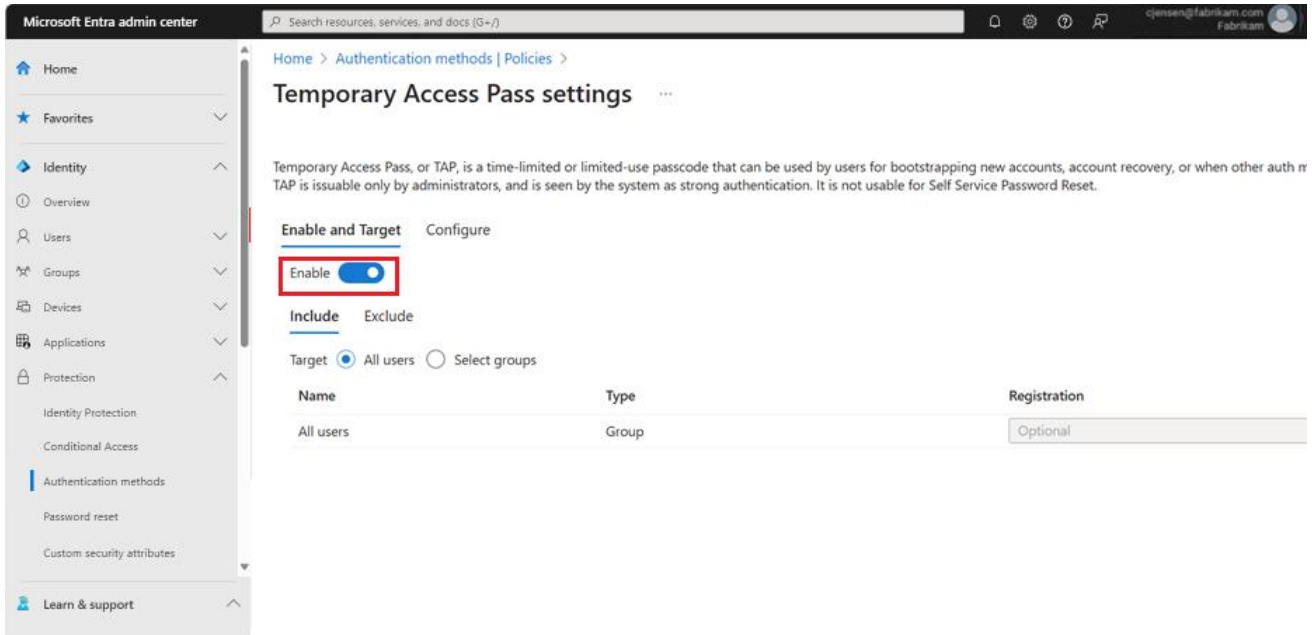
The screenshot shows the Microsoft Entra admin center interface. The left sidebar contains navigation options like User settings, Groups, Devices, Applications, Roles & admins, Billing, Settings, Protection, Identity Protection, Conditional Access, Security Center, Identity Secure Score, Multifactor authentication, and Authentication methods (highlighted with a red box). The main content area is titled 'Authentication methods | Policies' and shows a list of authentication methods. The 'Temporary Access Pass' method is highlighted with a red box in the list. The list includes methods like FIDO2 security key, Microsoft Authenticator, SMS, Temporary Access Pass, Hardware OATH tokens (Preview), Third-party software OATH tokens, Voice call, Email OTP, and Certificate-based authentication. The 'Enabled' column shows the status for each method.

Method	Target	Enabled
FIDO2 security key		No
Microsoft Authenticator		No
SMS		No
Temporary Access Pass		No
Hardware OATH tokens (Preview)		No
Third-party software OATH tokens		No
Voice call		No
Email OTP		Yes
Certificate-based authentication		No

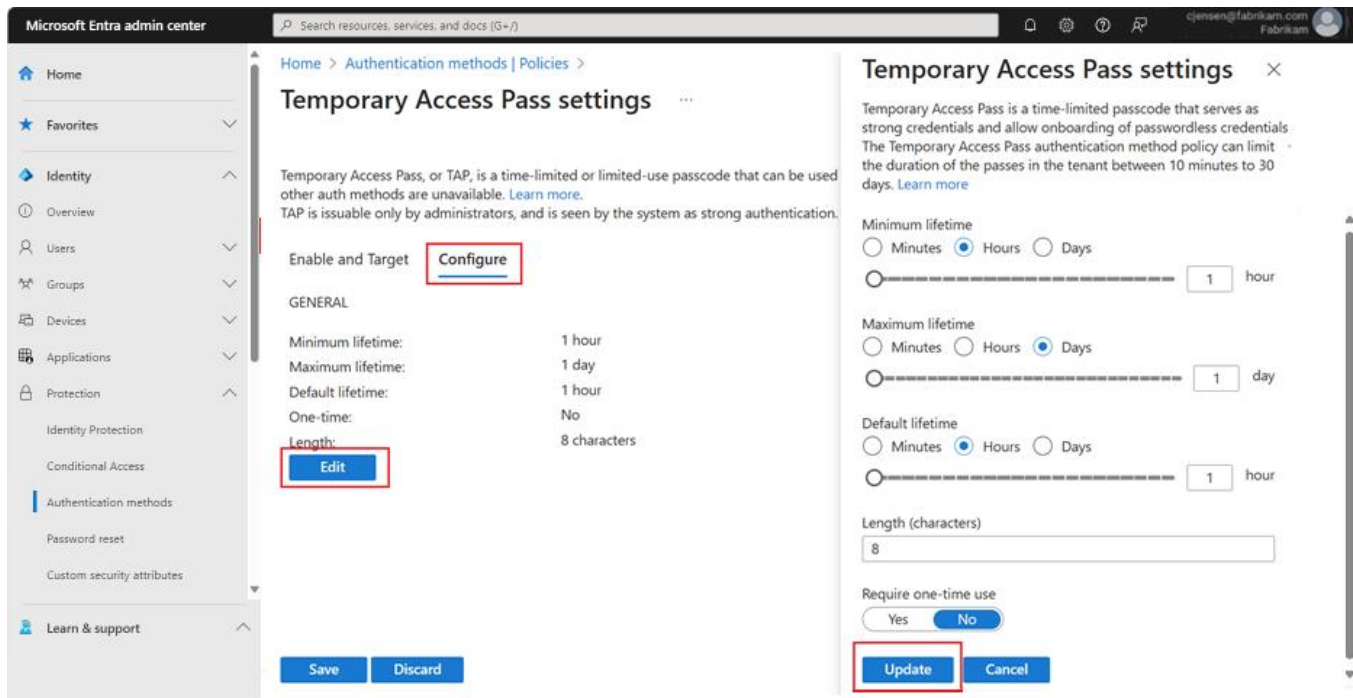
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4. Select **Enable** and then select users to include or exclude from the policy.



5. (Optional) Select **Configure** to modify the default Temporary Access Pass settings, such as setting maximum lifetime, or length, and select Update.



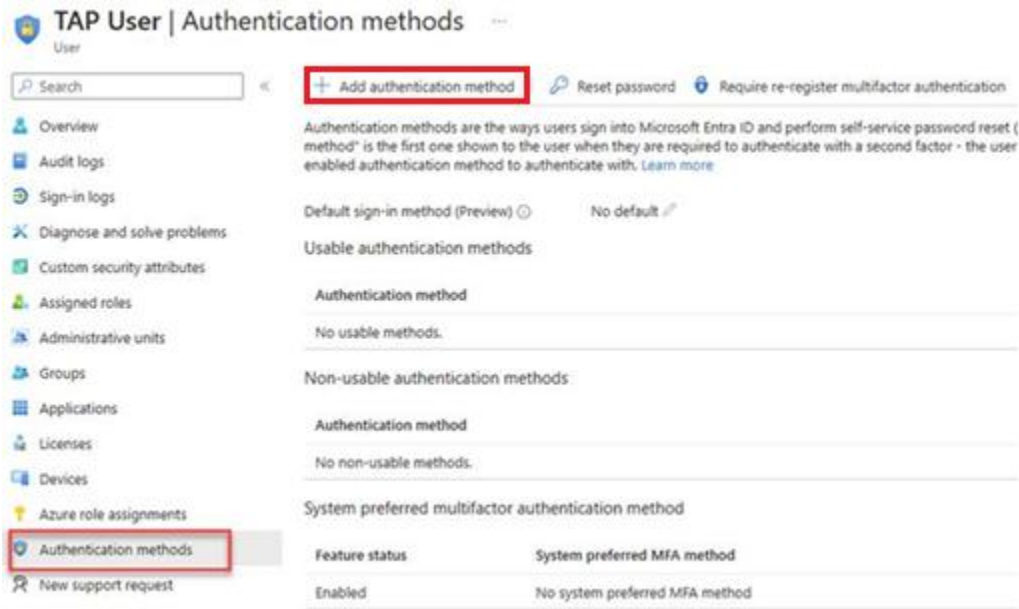
6. Select **Save** to apply the policy.

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Create a Temporary Access Pass (Admin Steps)

1. Go to Microsoft Entra Admin Center → <https://entra.microsoft.com>
2. Navigate: **Identity** → **Users** → **Select User**



3. Select: **Authentication methods** → **Temporary Access Pass** → **Add**

Add authentication method

Choose method

Temporary Access Pass

Create a Temporary Access Pass for TAP User. While the pass is valid, the user can use it to sign in and register strong credentials. [Learn more](#)

☐ Delayed start time

Activation duration ⌚

1

hours

One-time use

YesNo

Add

4. Configure:
 - One-time use
 - Lifetime: 1–8 hours
 - Activate immediately
 - Pass length: Default

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User Sign-In Experience

1. Start device and connect to Wi-Fi
2. Enter corporate email
3. Select **Sign-in options** → **Temporary Access Pass**
4. Enter TAP code
5. Complete setup:
 - Create password
 - Register MFA
 - Device auto-enrolls in Intune



Microsoft

←

Enter Temporary Access Pass

.....

☐ Show Temporary Access Pass

[Other ways to sign in](#)

Sign in

Best Practices

- Use TAP instead of temporary passwords
- Keep TAP short-lived and one-time use
- Deliver via secure, separate channel
- Ensure Intune + Autopilot are configured
- Verify device enrollment

Security Considerations

- TAP is **not a password**
- Expires automatically after use
- Should never be reused or stored
- Always enforce MFA registration

Sources:

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/entra/identity/authentication/howto-authentication-temporary-access-pass>

<https://techcommunity.microsoft.com/blog/itopstalkblog/step-by-step-guide--how-to-use-temporary-access-pass-tap-with-internal-guest-use/4365541>